

Balance

Our sense of balance allows us to stand, walk, or run without falling over. Special sensors in the inner part of each ear keep the brain updated about how upright we are and what movements the head is making.

Staying upright

There are three semicircular canals inside the ear that are filled with fluid. They contain balance sensors that detect body movements and send signals to the brain. These signals, together with signals from our eyes, pressure sensors in the skin on our feet, and stretch sensors in our muscles, are processed by the brain. The brain instructs the muscles to adjust the body's position so that it stays upright and balanced.



The ear's **semicircular canals** are set at right angles to each other and can detect head movement in any direction. Their swirling fluid triggers receptor cells to send signals to the brain.